

Author purpose - Workbook 1

Focused practice - Workbook 1 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Food Scrap Notice

Beginning Monday, households on the east route may place food scraps in the green bin. The notice lists accepted materials, collection day, and a phone number for replacement bins.

1. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. explain how residents should take part in a new food-scrap collection service
- B. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- C. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

2. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. The list of accepted materials prevents residents from putting unsuitable waste in the green bin.
- C. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- D. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.

Late Buses Editorial

An editorial argues that the final bus should leave downtown one hour later. It cites hospital and restaurant workers whose shifts often end after the current last departure.

3. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- B. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- C. persuade readers that later bus service would better serve late-shift workers
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

4. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- C. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.
- D. The worker examples show who is affected by the current schedule.

Moth Migration

A science article describes how researchers attach tiny tags to large moths and use receivers to detect them at different locations. It explains what the data can reveal about nighttime movement.

5. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. explain how scientists track moth movement and what the method can show
- B. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- C. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

6. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. Describing the tags helps readers understand how movement data are collected.
- C. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- D. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. Explain how residents should take part in a new food-scrap collection service.
2. B. The list of accepted materials prevents residents from putting unsuitable waste in the green bin.
3. C. Persuade readers that later bus service would better serve late-shift workers.
4. D. The worker examples show who is affected by the current schedule.
5. A. Explain how scientists track moth movement and what the method can show.
6. B. Describing the tags helps readers understand how movement data are collected.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.